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Торговые отношения и голосование в ООН по поводу русско-украинского конфликта

Программа Бакалавр экономики

Совместная программа по экономике НИУ ВШЭ и РЭШ

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Trade Relationships and Voting at the UN over the Russian-Ukrainian Conflict

Аннотация

Русско-Украинский конфликт, начавшийся в феврале 2022 года потряс не только страны блока СНГ или Европу, но и весь мир в целом. В моей дипломной работе я исследую голосования в Генеральной Ассамблее ООН по поводу этого конфликта, и изучаю как на голос страны могли повлиять объёмы международной торговли. Я также рассматриваю взаимосвязь между торговыми связями и санкциями. Я нахожу, что удвоение торговли с Российской Федерацией снижает вероятность того, что страна проголосует в пользу антироссийской резолюции на 3.5 процентных пункта, в то время как удвоение торговли на душу населения влияет еще больше (и значимо также для торговли с Украиной). Также я нахожу, что импорт российских зерновых оказывает значимое влияние, в то время как другие конкретные товары – нет. Наконец, я прогоняю инструментальную регрессию с использованием аварии в Суецком канале как инструмент для торговли. В этой спецификации я не получаю значимых результатов, однако этот результат скорее всего связан с локальным эффектом инструмента.

Abstract

The Russian-Ukrainian conflict that started in February 2022 was quite a shock to the whole European and World community. In this Thesis Project I focus on how countries vote in UN General Assembly resolutions related to this conflict and how their votes are affected by international trade. I also look at the relation between sanctions and said trade connections. I find that a doubling in trade with the Russian Federation decreases the probability of a country to vote in favor of an anti-Russian resolution by 3.5 percentage points. Trade per Capita appears to be more important with a coefficient of -6.5 percentage points for Russia and 9 percentage points for Ukraine. I do also find that Imports of Russian Cereals in particular have a strong effect, unlike other commodities. Finally, I conduct an instrumental regression using the accident in the Suez canal as an instrument for trade. I do not find any significant coefficients in this specification, though that might be attributable to the locality of the variability in trade provided by the instrument.

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1 Introduction

In February 2022 the whole world got shaken up by a conflict between Russia and Ukraine – the first full-scale war in Europe throughout the 21st century with more than 250 thousand causalities. This event captured the attention of many economists and a lot of different papers have been published since the beginning of that conflict. I join the group of researchers studying this topic and contribute with my Thesis work.

One of the interesting topics studied most in this sphere is how conflicts relate with international trade. The connection between trade and conflict might go both ways, with conflict affecting trade directly (through sanctions Glauber et al. (2023)), or the other way around, with interest in trade or resources affecting conflict occurrences (see, for example, Berger et al. (2013)). Most notably in this literature, Gallea et al. (2022) show that countries that are more central in natural gas trade are less prone to being sanctioned. I further this study out to other commodities and trade in general.

Besides considering international trade it might be very interesting to also look at non-economic international relationships, like support in UN voting. Here Binder and Lockwood Payton (2022) show that rising powers tend to form coalitions or blocks in the General Assembly. It seems reasonable that this voting behavior might be affected by conflicts or the other way around (see Pauls and Cranmer (2017)). In this thesis work I take a closer look at voting behavior in the context of the Russian-Ukrainian war specifically.

The idea is to combine the above two topics and look at the relationship between international trade and coalition-like behavior after the beginning of the Russian-Ukrainian conflict. To be more specific, I do some research on how economic ties (trade) of countries to the two sides of the conflict affect UN General Assembly (UN-GA) voting behavior in the case of unfavorable to Russia resolutions. In this work I try to help understand the motives of countries supporting either Russia or Ukraine in these resolutions or sanctions.

In order to get some more insights about these topics, I collect data on international trade, voting behavior and sanctions. I take UN Comtrade data for measuring economic connectivity between countries (being the total amount of trade and the amount of trade for specific commodities like Cereals), UN-GA voting data on resolutions of the A/RES/ES-11 type for a measure of voting behavior and the list of 'Unfriendly Countries' from the Russian Federation's governmental sources as a measure for sanctions.

I provide some – rather suggestive – evidence that Long Term Trade Relations might have some effects on Political Relations. I also show that short term variation in Trade has no effect at all.

I find that Trade with Russia appears to have a negative impact on voting in favor of anti-Russian resolutions. To be specific, a doubling in Total 2021 Trade with Russia (an increase of 1 IHS point) decreases the probability of voting in favor of resolution

A/RES/ES-11/1 ('Agression against Ukraine') by 3.5 percentage points. The same increase in Trade per Capita has an effect of -6.5 percentage points. At the same time I find that the amount of Trade with Ukraine has some significant effect (9 pp) only when measured in per capita terms. There is no effect when looking only at emerging and developing countries (though that might be due to a small sample size). When segregated, imports of Russian goods appear important while the effect of exports to Russia appears to be smaller and insignificant. Finally, I find that Cereals tend to be the only important one among the main commodities imported from Russia. This effect is negative, strongly significant and holds when controlling for Aid. Fuels (which include Gas and Oil) have no significant impact.

Finally, I conduct an instrumental regression, which is better when looking for causality since there are some concerns with endogeneity and omitted variables (OVB). I construct a measure of sensitivity of maritime trade with Russia to an accident in the Suez canal that occurred in March 2021 and made traveling to some countries take up more time. I look how this accident affected trade and take that as exogenous variation. Due to the exogenous nature of this accident the exclusion restriction should hold. The IV results show no significant effects of Trade on voting. This could be explained by different things. First, it could reflect the fact that Trade is actually not important and only shows positive coefficients in the linear probability model (LPM) due to OVB. Second, it could be a consequence of the instrument being rather weak (F-stat$\approx$ 7.6). Finally, it could imply a difference between the Average Treatment Effect (ATE) and the Local Average Treatment Effect (LATE). I provide some suggestive evidence towards the latter explanation.

My thesis builds on the existing literature in several directions. First, I contribute to work studying the relationship between conflicts, resources and international trade. There are a few papers about interventions focused on establishing a better trade connection. Berger et al. (2013) show that increases in political influence (in this case after CIA interventions) are sometimes used to shift the foreign market of the intervened country towards products of the influence (in this case the US). Dube et al. (2011) conduct a very similar work, studying asset prices in said interventions. At the same time Acemoglu et al. (2012) describe a dynamic theory of resource wars and study the conditions under which such wars can be prevented. Finally, Koubi et al. (2014) make a review of theoretical arguments as well as empirical findings linking natural resources to inter/intrastate conflict. I look rather in the opposite direction of effect and at whether more trade could lead to less conflict.

I also add to the study of how trade-connections might affect the reluctance to sanction a country, or in other words how economic ties might affect political actions. In this area, there is a paper by Gallea et al. (2022), who show that centrality in gas networks leads to political power of leaders as well as less political sanctions against. In the opposite direction, Alexander et al. (2023) provide some information about the consequences of

conflict on trade and food provision. More specifically, they show that higher fertilizer prices after the beginning of the Russian-Ukrainian conflict have had an even worse impact on food prices than direct sanctions like restrictions on export. Additionally, Glauber et al. (2023) study Russia-Ukraine war-related export restrictions and their effect on global food-insecurity. I look a little beyond sanctions and differentiate between commodities more than said papers do.

Finally, I contribute to an emerging literature that studies UN voting behavior and how it is related to different real outcomes like trade. In this context, Binder and Lockwood Payton (2022) show that rising economies tend to form coalitions and blocks to withstand the power of leading countries. Another paper by Pauls and Cranmer (2017) studies the effect of voting behavior on democracy, cooperation, trade and conflict. I look whether trade-relations might be in play here as well, and whether more economically connected countries could tend to co-vote.

The remainder of the paper is structured as follows: In Section 2 I describe the Setting of the conflict and UN-GA voting I am working with. In Section 3 I describe the data I use. In Section 4 I show the basic regression results. In Section 5 I do the Instrumental Variable regression. In Section 6 I conclude.

2 Setting

In this Section I describe the context I am working with. I try to be as much apolitical as possible. For any information on these topics please view other sources.

Crimea-Crisis. The Prequel

In early 2014 after several protests and the ousting of the pro-Russian president there was unrest erupting in eastern Ukraine. At the same time Russian troops took over Crimea and the city of Sevastopol. The Crimean government was dismissed, and on the 18th of March 2014, after a referendum was held in the regions, Russia claimed to officially include Crimea into Russian territory. After that Russian forces seized the Ukrainian military bases and all Ukrainian forces left the peninsula subsequently.

This event was widely condemned by the public, and on March 24 there was a General Assembly meeting resulting in the A/RES/68/262 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine' resolution. In that the General Assembly called upon respect to the integrity of Ukraine and deny any legal recognition of the referendum. More details on that, as well as on other resolutions, are provided in Appendix A.

What followed was the Donbass war which included events like pro-Russian protests in Novorossiya, armed conflicts of Ukrainian forces and separatists. The Ukrainians started an 'Anti-Terror Operation', while the Russians started sending 'humanitarian convoys'.

At some point in time international sanctions were imposed against Russia and Crimea by countries like the United States, Canada, and the European Union. Finally, after the second Minsk agreement, some sort of ceasefire was established with the war moving into static trench warfare and not many major events.

Russo-Ukrainian conflict. The Beginning

In the end of 2021 however, Russia started a major military buildup along the Ukrainian border. On the 21st February 2022 Putin announced that the Russian government would diplomatically recognize the Donetsk and Luhansk People's Republics. On 24 February 2022 Russia started the special military operation, which included an intrusion into Ukraine with tanks and other military equipment. Zelenskyy declared martial law and a general mobilization. The global community met this conflict with great discontent. More sanctions have been imposed on Russia additional to the ones from 2014.

Soon, an emergency meeting of the General Assembly was called, which resulted in the A/RES/ES-11/1, the first of many in that series. It deplored the invasion of Ukraine and demanded the withdrawal of Russian forces and a reversal of its decision to recognize the self-declared People's Republics of Donetsk and Luhansk. The resolution also confirmed the involvement of Belarus in the conflict.

First Months of the conflict. Humanitarian Conditions. Butcha

The first months of the conflict appear to be the most problematic for both sides. The most notorious problems were connected to humanitarian conditions. Both sides accused each other to use civilians as human shields, to attack medical infrastructure and to deliberately kill, torture and rape civilians. The perhaps strongest claims were against Russia, when their troops left the Kiev region. Many bodies of civilians were found and Russia was accused of having massacred more than 1200 people.

These events resonated deeply in the World community and soon several new plenary sessions were called forth. This resulted in two consecutive resolutions, one being a little stronger than the other. First, in resolution A/RES/ES-11/2 the UN reiterated its demand that Russia withdraw from Ukraine's recognized sovereign territory; it also deplored, expressed grave concern over, and condemned attacks on the civilian population and infrastructure. Second, the resolution A/RES/ES-11/3 suspended the membership of Russia in the United Nations Human Rights Council over 'grave concern at the ongoing human rights and humanitarian crisis in Ukraine'.

A few more months into the war. Mobilization in Russia

Between April and October several major events happened, including the siege of Mariupol, battles on the Kharkiv, Kherson and Zaporozhia fronts. At some point in September 2022 Ukraine launched a counteroffensive, while Russia started a partial militarization. At the same time referendums were held in the regions of Donetsk, Luhansk, Kherson and Zaporozhia by Russian officials. These referendums were immediately called invalid by most European countries and in turn lead to several other plenary sessions and two new resolutions.

In the first, A/RES/ES-11/4, the General Assembly declared that the referendums held in the mentioned regions were conducted under disputed circumstances and that they should not be recognized by the international community. It called upon all states to not recognize these territories as part of Russia. The second, A/RES/ES-11/5 had again a little stronger points than its precursor. In it, the UN-GA calls for Russia to pay war reparations to Ukraine and for the UN to create an international reparations mechanism.

The winter of 2022-23 resulted rather in a stalemate with less battles mostly around Bakhmut. On the 23 February 2023 the last until this date resolution A/RES/ES-11/6 was adopted. It was related to the anniversary of the beginning of the conflict and was about the UN Charter underlying a comprehensive, just and lasting peace in Ukraine. In its contents it was very similar to the ES-11/1 resolution.

For more information on any resolution, view Appendix A. I will not go further in describing the conflicts' development, since there were no more resolutions after that, and I am interested only in them.

3 Data

In order to look at the relation between international trade, voting behavior and sanctions I collect data on all three of these variables to later run a few simple regressions and look for any relations. I take UN Comtrade data for measuring economic connectivity between countries, UN-GA voting data on resolutions of the A/RES/ES-11 type for a measure of voting behavior and the list of 'Unfriendly Countries' from the Russian Federation's government as a measure for sanctions. In the first subsection I show how I get all the specific variables more in detail. In the second subsection I describe the data.

Data Collection

In order to get some measure for connectivity between countries I go to the UN COMTRADE website and download data on total imports and exports for each country in 2021 as well as 2013 (also a few other years for robustness checks). I collect data reported

by each country on trade with the Russian Federation, Ukraine and the whole World in total. For each country I also collect disaggregated data on imports of different commodities that account for more than 1% of Russian exports and for which Russia enters the top-10 exporters. There are 11 such Commodities at the first-level of the HS-classification (excluding commodity 99: Unspecified).

I take observations of a country only if it meets the following conditions: The country is recognized as a state by the UN and has a right to vote in the General Assembly (so, for example, states like Macao, Faroe and Palestine are excluded); The country is neither Russia nor Ukraine; The country has Trade data available for at least one of the two: Total Imports from the World or Total Exports to the World. The countries that don't meet the last requirement are usually third-world countries from Africa that don't have the ability to collect trade data or small city states that apparently don't trade much. I should say here that the countries not reporting total trade values with the World also do not report trade data with Russia or Ukraine specifically. This leaves me with 162 observations in 2013 and 151 observations in 2021. All unreported detailed trade values I set to zero.

The second part of the data, which I collect to measure political interactions, is UN General Assembly Voting Data on the topic of the Russian-Ukrainian Conflict. I need this to measure political relations, with the idea that countries supporting Russia to a certain extent would vote against any resolution that affects the Russian Federation in a bad way. At the same time countries that do not support Russia would rather support the anti-conflict resolutions than even abstain (Pauls and Cranmer (2017)).

I collect the votes on six resolutions that come after the beginning of the special military operation (to be specific those are the A/RES/ES-11/1, A/RES/ES-11/2, A/RES/ES-11/3, A/RES/ES-11/4, A/RES/ES-11/5, and A/RES/ES-11/6). Those resolutions were voted for on 27.02.2022, 24.03.2022, 07.04.2022, 14.11.2022, 10.12.2022 and 23.02.2023 accordingly. I also collect voting data for the A/RES/68/262 resolution from 27.03.2014 which happened after the Crimea crisis. The procedure of choosing these specific resolutions as well as a general description of the UN-GA system can be found in Appendix A.

To adopt a resolution there needs to be a simple majority of 'in favor' votes among all non-abstaining votes. Basically, this means that if you vote YES you support Ukraine (as for example Germany and the USA do), say that their territorial integrity was violated, and state that Russia should be stopped. If you abstain from voting it probably means that you slightly support Russia (like China and India), or that you don't agree with the need of actions against Russia. Now if you vote NO you strongly show your support of Russia (Belarus, North Korea, etc.). Finally, if you don't vote at all it is usually due to specific reasons for each country (not paying participation fees or being suspended). Here one interesting case is that neither Azerbaijan nor Armenia are voting in most of

the resolutions I look at (apparently due to their own conflict).

Most of the resolutions are very similar in content and voting behavior, as I show in the next subsection. There are two resolutions that differ a little bit though. First, there is the resolution on the "Suspension of the rights of membership of the Russian Federation in the Human Rights Council" (ES-11/3), where less countries vote in favor of the resolution than in the case of other ones. Second, there is the resolution on the "Furtherance of remedy and reparation for aggression against Ukraine", where again way less countries vote in favor of it. In terms of content these two resolutions differ from the others mostly in terms of actions: they both push the *UN* to do something, whereas all the other resolutions above are more or less about actions that *Russia* has to do. The "suspension of the rights..." resolution turns to a different question rather than just support/disapproval of Russia's actions. I should also say that the resolution from 2014 differs from the others for obvious reasons.

Now basically what I do for each resolution is to create several dummies for voting 'YES' (against 'NO' and 'ABSTAIN'), one for voting 'NO' (against 'YES' and 'ABSTAIN'), one for abstaining (against 'YES'/'NO') and one for not voting at all (against any of the three types of votes). I later look at different regressions using each dummy as outcome variable. Since some countries do not vote it leaves me with 141 to 145 observations for different resolutions.

Finally, I collect data on how sanctions are imposed by countries on the Russian Federation. I take the 'List of Unfriendly Countries' from official resources Government (2024), where the Russian government puts all the countries that sanctioned them in any way. I create a dummy called 'Unfriendly' that I set to 1 for each country that appears on the list.

Descriptive Statistics

In this subsection I describe the trade data as well as the main outcome variables in more detail. I first turn to the trade variables and then to the resolution variables.

The main problem I have to deal with when looking at trade data is the abundance of zero entrances in different observations. For example, not every country would import fish from Russia. Hence, taking simple logarithms is not an option, and I turn to the Inverse Hyperbolic Sine, which is defined as

$$IHS(Trade) = \log(Trade + \sqrt{Trade^2 + 1}).$$

Ut is commonly used as an alternative and is considered to be better than the logarithm of the value plus one. See, for example Norton (2022).

In Table 1 I show some basic descriptive statistics for aggregated trade values. I report the values for the whole 2021 sample, and I should note that the means might

differ slightly if taking only countries that vote or only developing countries.

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics for the Regressors

		N.Obs.	Mean	SD	Min	Max	IHS Mean	IHS SD
Export	Russia	151	\$1.69 Bn.	6.33 Bn.	\$0	\$67.2 Bn.	16.6	6.8
	Ukraine	151	\$377 M.	1.17 Bn.	\$0	\$9.29 Bn.	15.1	6.4
	World	151	\$132 Bn.	356 Bn.	\$8.9 M.	\$3.3 Tr.	23.9	2.7
Import	Russia	151	\$3.2 Bn.	8.57 Bn.	\$0	\$79.5 Bn.	19.3	4.5
	Ukraine	151	\$448 M.	1.12 Bn.	\$0	\$9.77 Bn.	17.7	4.2
	World	151	\$135 Bn.	366 Bn.	\$166 M.	\$2.9 Tr.	24.4	2.1
Total	Russia	151	\$4.89 Bn.	14.5 Bn.	\$0	\$147 Bn.	19.7	4.3
	Ukraine	151	\$826 M.	2.24 Bn.	\$0	\$19 Bn.	18.1	4.1
	World	151	\$267 Bn.	712 Bn.	\$182 M.	\$6 Tr.	25	2.3

Notes: Data is from the UN Comtrade Database. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UN-GA and have aggregated Trade data available at least relative to the World. The Inverse Hyperbolic Sine is defined as $IHS(y) = \ln(y + \sqrt{y^2 + 1})$.

One qualitative thing that I notice is that (obviously) countries trade way more with Russia than they do with Ukraine. Total Trade with Russia averages at \$4.89 Billion, while Total Trade with Ukraine is about \$826 Million. Both Russia and Ukraine appear to be Net Exporters with Imports from Russia being almost twice the value of Exports to it on average (\$3.2 Billion vs. \$1.69 Billion). The minimums of any trade component with either Russia or Ukraine is zero, since there is always at least one country that does not trade at all. At the same time the minimum of Total Trade with the World is always positive by construction of the dataset. The maximum of trade with Russia is almost \$150 for China, while the maximum for Ukraine is only at about \$20 Billion, nearly 7.5 times less.

Since I am working mostly with IHS data it also makes sense to look at that. The average IHS export to Russia is about 16.6, while it is 15.1 for Ukraine. Average Imports are more than 1.5 IHS points higher, with values of 19.3 and 17.7. I should note that standard deviations are quite high, amounting for more that a third of the mean for imports and about a quarter for exports. In summary statistics not reported I also find that per capita trade with Russia averages at about \$250 (mean IHS at 3.9), while per capita trade with Ukraine averages at \$42 (mean IHS at 2.5).

Now when turning to UN-GA-voting data, first of all I should say that most countries had similar voting behavior over most resolutions regardless of the topic: for each of the resolutions except A/RES/ES-11/3 and A/RES/ES-11/5 there were 140-143 votes for, 5-7 votes against, 32-38 abstentions and 10-13 non-voters. The average amount of countries that shift their opinion between voting options for the 'regular' resolutions is about 6.5 between each two cases. The different shifts are split almost equally between

yes-to-abstain shifts, no-to-abstain shifts and the opposite directions accordingly. There is not a single observation, where a country would shift its vote from YES to NO or the other way around. Also, there are several countries that change from not voting to voting throughout the period.

Table 2: Descriptive Statistics for the Outcomes

	YES	NO	ABSTAIN	Absent	N.Voting(Total)
A/RES/ES-11/1 (02.03.2022)	0.804	0.007	0.189	0.053	143(151)
A/RES/ES-11/2 (24.03.2022)	0.772	0.007	0.221	0.040	145(151)
A/RES/ES-11/3 (07.04.2022)	0.539	0.121	0.340	0.066	141(151)
A/RES/ES-11/4 (12.10.2022)	0.793	0.014	0.193	0.040	145(151)
A/RES/ES-11/5 (14.11.2022)	0.539	0.050	0.411	0.066	141(151)
A/RES/ES-11/6 (23.02.2022)	0.794	0.014	0.191	0.066	141(151)
A/RES/68/262 (24.03.2014)	0.590	0.049	0.361	0.111	144(162)
Sanctions Imposed	0.278	0.722			151

Notes: Data is from the UN Comtrade Database. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UN-GA (column 4), have voted (columns 1 – 3) and have Trade data available at least relative to the World. The resolutions in question are the 'Aggression against Ukraine', 'Humanitarian consequences of the aggression against Ukraine', 'Suspension of the rights of membership of the Russian Federation in the Human Rights Council', 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine: defending the principles of the Charter of the United Nations', 'Furtherance of remedy and reparation for aggression against Ukraine', 'Principles of the Charter of the United Nations underlying a comprehensive, just and lasting peace in Ukraine', and the 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine' resolutions. The Sanctions Imposed variable is defined as a country being present on the 'List of Unfriendly Countries' published by Russia.

In the regressions that I do in this work, I focus mostly on three resolutions: A/RES/ES-11/1, that was held on 27.02.2022 and is very similar to most of the other resolutions; A/RES/ES-11/3, that was held on 07.04.2022 and is a little different by having more NO and ABSTAIN votes; and finally, A/RES/68/262, that was held on 02.03.2014 and is interesting for comparison. Furthermore, I also use the 'Unfriendly to Russia' dummy, since it represents a different approach to political relations, and might provide some additional results to the voting data regressions. In Table 2, I show the average of each dummy. We can see, that the 'regular' resolutions get on average about 80% of 'YES' votes, while the 'special' resolutions as well as the resolution from 2014 both collect YES-votes ranging from about 55% to 60%. Finally, we can see that almost 30% of the countries in the world have sanctioned or in any way affected Russia to get on their 'Unfriendlies' list.

I should also note that in most resolutions there are almost no countries voting against. This is so because both North Korea and Eritrea (both voting for 'NO' in every resolution) fail to report any trade data, while Russia is excluded from the sample manually. This leaves us with Belarus and sometimes Syria (which doesn't vote in some of the resolutions). About ten countries are absent in most resolutions, which is about 6.5% of the sample.

The countries absent vary over time and usually have different country-specific reasons. Notably, more countries are absent in the 2014 resolution, which leads to a similar sample size even though the initial (trade) 2014-sample is larger.

Table 3: Disaggregated Trade and UN-GA Voting

	Place of Russia	Mean for Russia	Place of Ukraine	Mean for Ukraine	Number of Obs.
Fuels	4	\$1.76 Bn.	83	\$7.0 M.	151
Precious Metals	8	\$246 M.	88	\$823 K.	151
Iron	4	\$199 M.	15	\$91.2 M	151
Fertilizers	1	\$89.5 M.	24	\$4.5 M.	151
Wood	4	\$81.6 M.	25	\$14.9 M.	151
Aluminum	6	\$66.1 M.	68	\$753 K.	151
Cereals	6	\$60.2 M.	4	\$80.3 M.	151
Copper	9	\$57.9 M.	60	\$1.1 M.	151
Ores	9	\$53.7 M.	10	\$55.0 M.	151
Fish	6	\$46.6 M.	80	\$364 K.	151
Fats, Oils	7	\$31.3 M.	5	\$44.5 M.	151

Notes: Data is from the UN Comtrade Database. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UN-GA and have aggregated Trade data available at least relative to the World. Commodities: All that account for more than 1% of Russian Export and for which Russia is among the top-10 Exporters in the World. The Places of Russia and Ukraine are taken when looking at Commodity Export data reported by all Countries.

When looking at disaggregated trade we can see that there are two main groups present on the top-exports: natural resources and food provision. One can also notice that fuels (HS-27), which is a commodity code that includes both natural gas and fossil oil, is by far the largest import from Russia. We can see, that Russia takes the first place only for fertilizers, while it enters the top-10 quite often. The biggest imports from Ukraine are iron, cereals, and ores.

As the main controls I take data on physical distances as well as dummies on contingency and common language, GDP per capita, population and finally data on foreign aid. Obviously, both trade (as in De Benedictis and Taglioni (2011)) and voting (Kim and Russett (1996)) could be affected by physical characteristics like distance, a common border or language. Hence, I take data from the GeoDist database Mayer and Zignago (2011) that contains dummies on contingency, common languages, different colony variables as well as distances between the biggest cities, the capitals and a weighted measure of distance between cities in total. I take Population data from the worldpopulationreview and GDP per capita from the World Bank database Bank (2021). It appears to make sense to control for GDP, even though I also control for total trade with the world in every specification. Additionally, I take data on bilateral foreign aid (total receipts) from the

OECD iLibrary OECD (2021) and construct variables of total foreign aid as well as US foreign aid. I do this since foreign aid, and aid by the US in particular has been shown to affect voting behavior (see, for example Bailey et al. (2017)). I also control for a dummy on a country being an UN Security Council (UNSC) member. Finally, I use continent fixed effects (FE).

4 Results

Throughout this section I use the simple linear probability model (LPM), namely:

$$y_c = \alpha + \beta Trade_c + \gamma Controls_c + \epsilon_c,$$

where y_c is the outcome variable, being either a dummy for voting in a specific way in a given resolution, or being present on the list of countries unfriendly to Russia. $Trade_c$ is a vector of trade-related variables that, depending on the specification, might include data on total or per capita trade with Russia, Ukraine or the whole World, as well as more specified data on Import, Export, Net Export, or disaggregated commodity-trade data. $Controls_c$ is a vector of controls that includes data on physical distance contingency, colonial dependency and common language, log GDP per capita, log population, a dummy on being a member of the UNSC and continental fixed effects. In some of the specifications foreign aid data is also included in the controls. Finally, ϵ_c is the error term.

Results

My most basic results are presented in Table 4. Panel A shows the results for a regression with voting-behavior in the A/RES/ES-11/1 'Aggression against Ukraine' resolution being the outcome. We can see that higher values of Trade with Russia are associated with a lower probability of voting in favor of the resolution and with a higher probability of abstaining. The coefficients are almost identical but of the opposite sign with the absolute value at about 0.034. The results for voting 'NO' are inconclusive, since there is only one observation in this group. Creating a measure of political support to Russia on a 0-2 point basis (where 'YES' is 0, 'ABSTAIN' is 1, and 'NO' is 2) also reflects only the YES-to-ABSTAIN shift. Additionally, we can see, that the coefficients on trade values with Ukraine are of opposite signs, smaller, and insignificant. The absolute value here is 0.20. Coefficients on trade with the rest of the world are statistically close to zero. Finally, we can see that there is no notable difference in trade between countries that vote and countries that are absent, which means there is no attenuation bias.

These results can be interpreted as an indication towards the fact that higher trade with Russia and lower trade with Ukraine is associated with a higher probability of being more supportive of Russia and less supportive of Ukraine in UN General Assembly voting.

Table 4: Trade and UN-GA-voting behavior

Panel A: Resolution A/RES/ES-11/1 of the 2nd March 2022					
	Voting in Resolution 'Aggression against Ukraine' (The establishment of the fact, deploration and condemnation of)				
	YES	NO	ABSTAIN	Absent	0-2/Y-A-N
IHS Trade Russia	-0.035**	0.001	0.034**	0.002	0.035**
	(0.016)	(0.001)	(0.016)	(0.006)	(0.017)
IHS Trade Ukraine	0.020	0.001	-0.022	0.003	-0.019
	(0.018)	(0.001)	(0.018)	(0.009)	(0.018)
IHS Trade World	0.018	0.008	-0.026	-0.015	-0.010
	(0.069)	(0.007)	(0.069)	(0.041)	(0.070)
Mean	0.804	0.007	0.188	0.054	0.201
Number of Obs.	144	144	144	152	144
Adj. R-Squared	0.280	0.549	0.264	0.054	0.316
F-Test	30.22	0.234	47.97	0.456	20.14
Prob > F	0.000	1.000	0.000	0.987	0.000
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

Panel B: Resolution A/RES/ES-11/3 of the 7th April 2022					
	Voting in Resolution 'Suspension of the rights of membership of the Russian Federation in the Human Rights Council'				
	YES	NO	ABSTAIN	Absent	0-2/Y-A-N
IHS Trade Russia	-0.005	0.021	-0.016	-0.008	0.025
	(0.020)	(0.013)	(0.021)	(0.014)	(0.027)
IHS Trade Ukraine	-0.010	-0.010	0.020	-0.008	0.000
	(0.019)	(0.015)	(0.019)	(0.015)	(0.028)
IHS Trade World	-0.207***	-0.028	0.234***	0.050	0.179*
	(0.071)	(0.065)	(0.087)	(0.047)	(0.104)
Mean	0.539	0.121	0.340	0.066	0.585
Number of Obs.	142	142	142	152	142
Adj. R-Squared	0.471	0.185	0.275	0.060	0.438
F-Test	18.93	35.19	4.960	0.599	20.41
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.931	0.000
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UN-GA (column 4), voted in the resolution (columns 1 – 3, and 5), and have Trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The outcome variable '0-2' takes the value 0 for 'YES', 1 for 'ABSTAIN' and 2 for 'NO'. The definitions of the regressors are in the text, with Data taken as of the year 2021. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UN Security Council.

An increase in one log (ihs) point of trade with Russia, which is approximately a doubling in value, is associated with a decrease of the probability of voting in favor of the resolution by 3.4 percentage points, or a reduction of 4.2% relative to the mean.

Panel B shows the results for a regression with voting-behavior in the A/RES/ES-11/3 'Suspension of the rights of membership of the Russian Federation in the Human Rights Council' resolution being the outcome variable. Here, there are more countries shifted toward voting 'NO'. There is a positive but insignificant coefficient on trade with Russia when looking at which countries voted against the resolution (the p-value is 17.7%). There is also a negative but even more vague effect of Trade with Russia when looking at Abstaining countries. The above two effects appear to be offsetting when looking at countries that voted 'YES'. The coefficients on Trade with Ukraine and Trade with the whole World are all insignificant. Finally, we can again find that there is no notable difference in trade between countries that vote and countries that are absent.

Table 5 shows what happens when we include basic controls or the control for foreign aid (IHS total receipts) into the model. The coefficients become smaller, but in case of A/RES/ES-11/1 remain significant. Foreign Aid, neither when taken as received from all DAC countries in total, nor when taken as received from the US in particular, does not account for a lot of change. This control for Foreign Aid is important especially in light of works like Bailey et al. (2017).

Table 6 shows the coefficients for per Capita Trade. This might make more sense, since people might get personally more affected by Russia when using Russian products more often, and political actions could stem from that. At the same time a simple measure of Trade (controlling for population and GDP) could show a countries' economic dependency on Russia. I take the latter one for more important, but this table should definitely be considered as well. Especially since we can see effects that are higher in magnitude. Here, a doubling of Trade with Russia per citizen is related to a 6.5 percentage point reduction in the probability of voting 'YES'. A doubling in trade with Ukraine for each citizen is associated with a 9 percentage point increase in the probability of voting 'YES'. It is important to notice that it is even higher in magnitude than for Russia (while, obviously, going the opposite direction). This was not the case when looking at total trade, so it appears that Ukraine Trades with smaller partners and affects them more.

I report several additional results in appendix B. Table 10 shows the effects in case of only developing, emerging countries and for countries that are either one of the two. All coefficients are insignificant, which might point towards the fact that the difference driver is within the developed countries or within the gap between developed and developing countries. An insignificant coefficient could also be accounted to a very small sample size, so one should be careful in interpreting these results.

In Table 11 from appendix B I look at all other resolutions of the 11th emergency special session as well as the resolution from 2014. We can see that resolutions ES-11/2 and

ES-11/6 are to some extent similar to resolution ES-11/1. Resolution 2 shows a stronger effect. At the same time resolution 4 reports very small and insignificant coefficients though in the same direction as resolution 1. Resolution ES-11/5 'Furtherance of remedy and reparation for aggression against Ukraine' and the 2014 resolution differ drastically with no single coefficient being statistically significant. This is due to the fact that they are different in content (stronger, for ES-11/5) or simply historically different. The effect of Trade per capita is also similar to resolution ES-11/1.

Table 5: The effect of Trade Volumes on UN-GA-voting behavior, controlling for Aid

	Voting Behavior in the Resolution					
	A/RES/ES-11/1 (03.02.2022) Aggression against Ukraine			A/RES/ES-11/3 (07.04.2022) Suspension of the membership of Russia in the HR Council		
	YES	YES	YES	NO	NO	NO
IHS Trade RUS	-0.059***	-0.035**	-0.034**	0.045***	0.021	0.024
	(0.018)	(0.016)	(0.017)	(0.016)	(0.013)	(0.014)
IHS Trade UKR	0.018	0.020	0.021	-0.005	-0.010	-0.010
	(0.019)	(0.018)	(0.018)	(0.013)	(0.015)	(0.015)
IHS Trade World	0.080***	0.018	0.015	-0.074***	-0.028	-0.026
	(0.027)	(0.069)	(0.070)	(0.028)	(0.065)	(0.066)
IHS Total Aid			-0.011			0.007
			(0.012)			(0.011)
IHS US Aid			0.005			-0.026
			(0.018)			(0.018)
Mean	0.804	0.804	0.804	0.121	0.121	0.121
Number of Obs.	144	144	144	142	142	142
Adj. R-Squared	0.070	0.280	0.272	0.064	0.185	0.189
F-Test	5.336	30.22	71.65	3.057	35.19	45.26
Prob > F	0.002	0.000	0.000	0.031	0.000	0.000
Controls	N	Y	Y	N	Y	Y
Continent FE	N	Y	Y	N	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UN-GA, voted in the resolution, and have Trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text, with Data taken as of the year 2021. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UN Security Council.

In what follows I use resolution ES-11/1 as a representative resolution for most of the

Table 6: The effect of Trade per Capita on Voting

	YES in Resolution A/RES/ES-11/1			
	Full Sample		Dev & Emg	
IHS Trade PC Russia	-0.065**	-0.067**	-0.066	-0.068
	(0.031)	(0.032)	(0.048)	(0.050)
IHS Trade PC Ukraine	0.090**	0.089**	0.087*	0.086
	(0.037)	(0.038)	(0.051)	(0.053)
IHS Trade PC World	0.000	0.005	-0.081	-0.080
	(0.077)	(0.077)	(0.110)	(0.114)
IHS Total Aid PC		0.010		-0.008
		(0.020)		(0.033)
IHS US Aid PC		-0.011		0.005
		(0.028)		(0.045)
Mean	0.592	0.049	0.278	0.278
Number of Obs.	144	144	98	98
Adj. R-Squared	0.308	0.297	0.234	0.213
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text, with Data taken as of the year 2021. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UN Security Council.

ES-11 series. I should note that this resolution is not really the same as all the others, so I look at resolutions 3, 5 and 68/262 more in detail in unreported tests, where I do not have any interesting findings. I should also note here that the absence of findings could also be a finding, and that the resolution I look at is weaker in content. Apparently, I rather get the effect for support (of Ukraine) in *words* than the effect for support in *actions*. When looking at basic results, I might suggest that when having more serious decisions to make, countries are handling according more to political reasoning than to economic ties. They are more easily affected by economic benefits when their choices have no big consequences behind them. However, this goes beyond the scope of my project.

In Table 13 I show the effects of Trade values on being present on the list of countries unfriendly to Russia, which I take as a measure of sanctions imposed on Russia. The presence on the list is taken as of March 2023. I report two regressions with trade data taken from 2013 and 2021, since both years were followed by the imposition of sanctions on Russia and might have had some effect. We can see that there is pretty much no effect of Trade with either Russia or Ukraine on being present on the list. This result holds in both cases of the year of trade data measurement. However, there appears to be some (insignificant) effect on total trade with the world, which suggests that countries that are bigger players in international trade (holding GDP constant) are more likely to put sanctions on Russia. This might make sense, because only sanctions imposed by countries trading much would actually be effective and affect Russia.

Disaggregated Trade Data

Next, I look at Dissagregated data. I first turn to separating Exports and Imports. The idea is that Imports from Russia might make a country more dependent than Exports towards Russia, especially if the country critically relies on some goods (like food). Table 15 from appendix B shows some support for this. I do not report the coefficients for Ukraine and the World, since I am more interested in Russia. However, both things are included as controls and are insignificant. We can see that Imports appear to be of a slightly higher importance than Exports with a decrease of yes-voting probability of 2.4 and 1.7 percentage points accordingly. The coefficient on imports from Russia is also statistically significant, while the coefficient on exports to Russia is not. We can also see that the Net Exports have absolutely no impact while all that matters is Total Trade if looking this way. We can interpret this as economic ties being more important than trade dependence on goods in this context.

Finally, I turn to disaggregated trade data and different commodities of Import from Russia (and Ukraine). I look which goods are most important for political relations with Russia. In Tables 7 and 8 I provide the results for a regression of voting 'YES' in the A/RES/ES-11/1 on Imports of the different commodities. Column 1 and 2 of Table 7

Table 7: The effect of trade volumes on UN-GA-voting Behavior. Disaggregated Trade Data

	Voting YES in resolution A/RES/ES-11/1			
	IHS Import from		IHS Import from	
	Russia	Ukraine	Russia	Ukraine
Fuels	0.009	-0.012	0.004	-0.012
	(0.010)	(0.009)	(0.008)	(0.009)
Precious Metals	0.002	-0.014	-0.006	-0.011
	(0.008)	(0.011)	(0.008)	(0.011)
Iron	-0.008	0.003	-0.003	0.001
	(0.014)	(0.010)	(0.015)	(0.011)
Fertilizers	0.008	0.011	0.003	0.010
	(0.010)	(0.007)	(0.010)	(0.007)
Wood	0.004	-0.010	-0.001	-0.003
	(0.014)	(0.015)	(0.014)	(0.014)
Cereals	-0.024***	-0.009	-0.024***	-0.009
	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.008)	(0.007)
Aluminum	0.005	0.015	0.006	0.015
	(0.012)	(0.010)	(0.011)	(0.010)
Ores	-0.007	0.008	-0.004	0.008
	(0.008)	(0.009)	(0.008)	(0.009)
Copper	-0.005	-0.003	-0.000	-0.003
	(0.006)	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.008)
Fish	-0.000	0.018**	-0.003	0.016*
	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.007)	(0.007)
Fats, Oils	0.002	0.008	0.003	0.008
	(0.008)	(0.007)	(0.008)	(0.007)
Mean	0.804		0.804	
Number of Obs.	144		144	
Adj. R-Squared	0.367		0.372	
F-Test	17.32		29.71	
Prob > F	0.000		0.000	
Foreign Aid Control	N		Y	
Other Controls	Y		Y	
Continent FE	Y		Y	

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Commodities: All that account for more than 1% of Russian Export and for which Russia is among the top-10 Exporters in the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text with Data taken as of the year 2021. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, a dummy for being in the UN Security Council, IHS Total Trade of countries with Russia, Ukraine and the World accordingly as well as Total Imports (from the World) of the given goods.

Table 8: The effect of Trade per Capita on UN-GA-voting Behavior. Disaggregated Trade Data

	Voting YES in resolution A/RES/ES-11/1			
	IHS Import PC from		IHS Import PC from	
	Russia	Ukraine	Russia	Ukraine
Fuels	0.018	0.096	0.013	0.100
	(0.032)	(0.069)	(0.033)	(0.070)
Precious Metals	0.038	-0.030	0.037	-0.036
	(0.030)	(0.076)	(0.030)	(0.082)
Iron	0.031	-0.010	0.040	-0.010
	(0.049)	(0.048)	(0.048)	(0.048)
Fertilizers	0.006	-0.168	0.012	-0.196*
	(0.044)	(0.110)	(0.043)	(0.117)
Wood	-0.190**	-0.006	-0.207**	-0.016
	(0.093)	(0.094)	(0.098)	(0.096)
Cereals	-0.159***	0.049	-0.166***	0.050
	(0.054)	(0.043)	(0.053)	(0.043)
Aluminum	0.031	0.292	0.036	0.281
	(0.051)	(0.197)	(0.051)	(0.199)
Ores	0.040	-0.033	0.042	-0.032
	(0.061)	(0.063)	(0.061)	(0.062)
Copper	-0.006	0.178	-0.008	0.181
	(0.043)	(0.167)	(0.043)	(0.171)
Fish	0.003	-0.233	0.003	-0.241
	(0.044)	(0.230)	(0.045)	(0.226)
Fats, Oils	0.120*	0.041	0.127*	0.042
	(0.061)	(0.048)	(0.065)	(0.048)
Mean	0.804		0.804	
Number of Obs.	144		144	
Adj. R-Squared	0.266		0.257	
F-Test	41.08		43.15	
Prob > F	0.000		0.000	
Foreign Aid Control	N		Y	
Other Controls	Y		Y	
Continent FE	Y		Y	

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Commodities: All that account for more than 1% of Russian Export and for which Russia is among the top-10 Exporters in the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text with Data taken as of the year 2021. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, a dummy for being in the UN Security Council, IHS Trade PC of countries with Russia, Ukraine and the World accordingly as well as IHS Imports PC (from the World) of the given goods.

show the regression results with no control for aid while in Columns 3 and 4 there is a regression with said controls. We can see that almost no Commodity has a significant effect on voting behavior, with the only exception being Russian Cereals, which has significant coefficients in all specifications. A doubling of Imports of Russian cereals has a strong significant negative effect of 2.4 percentage points, while a doubling of Imports per Capita has an effect of more than 16 percentage points. This might lead us towards the idea that countries that rely on Russia in food-related goods are more likely to be biased in their voting behavior towards more Russia-friendly voting than countries that are dependent on resources (you don't starve if driving your car becomes more expensive). Looking at food and natural resources more in detail might also be a good idea for future research. Some other commodities worth noting are Ukrainian Fish and Russian Wood, though the former might be driven by outliers as it is shown in Appendix B, and the latter is only significant in per Capita Trade.

5 Instrumental Regression

This Section describes the instrumental variable (IV) that I use to create exogenous variability in Trade with Russia and shows the results I get. I take a variable measuring the dependence of Maritime Connectivity to Russia on the Suez canal being opened, which shows the exposure to an exogenous shock in case of a blockage. The first subsection describes the Chronology of the blockage in March 2021 and shows the effects a blockage has on the World and Russia in particular, the second subsection tells the narrative how this shock satisfies both the information restriction and the exclusion restriction, while the last two subsections explain the variable itself, show some descriptive statistics as well as regression results.

Chronology of the Accident and Impacts on the World

In the morning of 23 March 2021 the Ever Given container ship had run aground in the Suez canal, causing a full blockage of traffic. This was mainly a consequence of strong winds, almost a sandstorm, but human errors might also have been involved. The obstruction happened in the section of the canal, where there is only one channel, so other ships had no way around it. The ship was freed by tugs only six days later, on 29 March, and towed towards the Great Bitter Lake for technical inspection. Shipping was resumed at 19:00 EGY (17:00 UTC) that day. However, the queue of almost 400 ships on the two sides of the canal would still have to wait to pass through, with the last affected ship scheduled to pass almost two weeks later Gast et al. (2021).

This accident had great impact on the World economy especially through its effects on international trade. According to Gokan et al. (2024) the net negative impact of

the blockage totaled 79.6 billion USD, which was 0.1% of the world's GDP in 2021. At the same time there were winners and loosers with a massive shift towards other trade routes/partners. Gokan et al. (2024) show that the US might have benefited from the blockage by nearly $60 Billion, while China lost about $73 Billion. Russia was rather on the winning end with a net effect of about $8.8 Billion. Besides the direct effect like delays and rerouting of specific shipments there was also a major indirect effect with the World starting to think about alternatives like Cape Town or the Northern Sea Route as shown in Wan et al. (2023).

Instrument Validity and Mechanism

The Suez canal blockage might have affected Russia in two ways. On one hand, as shown in Wan et al. (2023) the most affected vessels were container ships as well as petrochemical tankers. In both ways this could negatively affect the export of Russian grain and oil accordingly. At the same time, by countries or firms choosing new trade routes and partners, Russia could have benefited quite well. Russia is easily accessible as a partner for both export and import for many countries, since it is quite big and has many ports in both the Pacific and the Atlantic. Russia is also the provider of the Northern Sea Trade Route, which looks more appealing in the lights of global warming since it doesn't depend on any needle threads like the Suez or Panama canal and is the shorter route for many port pairs.

It is important that countries' trade with Russia could be affected in these two ways. The difference here is not only the direction of change, but also it's essence: a temporary break in trade of oil, even for almost a month and even if causing millions in losses, is still *temporary* and could be restored later on, whereas major shifts that change the state of the world permanently would cause a change in trade that is much more meaningful. In this sense, if the variability that dependence on the Suez canal gives for trade has a temporary nature, then the Local Average Treatment Effect (LATE) might differ from the Average Treatment Effect (ATE) on political relations (short term distractions might have little effect on long term relations). On the other hand, a long-lasting change in trade patterns could actually lead to a change in political relations with the LATE being equal to the ATE. There are several papers that use the closing of the Suez in 1967 as an instrument for trade (for example Feyrer (2021)), but that closing was way longer: almost eight years. In the last subsection, I study whether for Russia specifically a shorter closure could also have a permanent effect, and find evidence rather towards the opposite.

Now, about the exclusion restriction (ER). First of all, it is highly doubtful that a blockage of the canal would in any direct way affect political relations with Russia, so a direct violation of the ER appears not to be in place. There is a problem however, which is that a variable measuring the dependence of trade with Russia for countries has

a big correlation with geographic factors. For example Gokan et al. (2024) show that African countries are in terms of GDP affected most (negatively) by the accident, while North American countries are affected least (or are actually affected positively). Hence, it appears reasonable to control for continent FEs.

There could also be lots of other effects that the Suez canal on its own had historically on trade and political relations. If we look at a simple regression of IHS trade with Russia in 2020 (a year not affected by the accident) on the Suez variable (described below) we see significant coefficients. Hence it might make sense to get rid of some historical endogeneity. Now what I do is use the Suez variable as an instrument for Trade with Russia in 2021, *controlling for Trade in 2020*. This variability appears to be reasonably exogenous. I give some suggestive evidence for that in the last subsection.

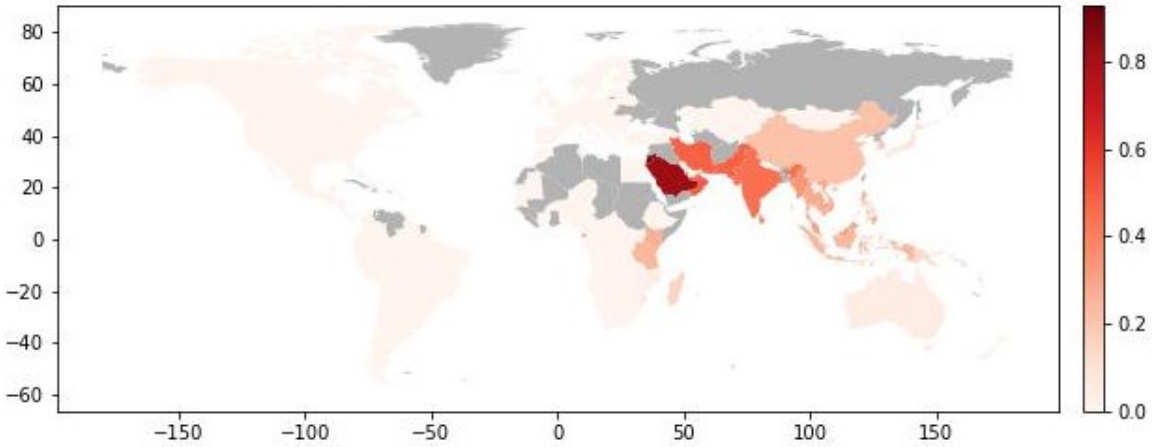
Another concern is that the Suez blockage might have affected not only trade with Russia, but also with other countries. I deal with that by instrumenting Ukrainian and World Trade too.

Descriptive Statistics

I take the Suez Variable from Feyrer (2021) who also uses it as an instrument for trade. The variable is constructed as follows: first, bilateral sea distances are created using geographic data. The average traveling time (in days) is computed for country pairs using their primary ports and a ship speed set to 20 knots plus the average ocean current. The log traveling time is computed for both when the Suez canal is open and when it is closed. I take this data from Feyrer (2021) and compute a variable called 'Suez Russia'. It is the difference between log traveling days to Russia (Novorossiysk) when the Suez is *closed* minus log traveling days to Russia when the canal is *open*, so that it is either zero or positive. The former is for countries that have no access to sea or countries for which the shortest connection to Russia does not include the Suez canal, like Spain and or Laos. The latter is for those countries for which the shortest route does include the Suez canal, like Kenya and India. I also construct a similar variable 'Suez Ukraine' and 'Suez Total'. 'Suez Total' is the average Suez effect for a country relative to distances to all other countries.

In the picture below I show a map illustrating the effect. A histogram can be found in Appendix C. The map shows countries in a darker red for greater values of the 'Suez Russia' variable. Grey countries are those not present in the dataset as described in section 3. The mean of the variable is 0.063, the maximum is almost one (0.93) for Saudi Arabia, which means traveling time almost doubled. We can also notice that one should be careful with zero-values and geographical effects.

Figure 1: Map of the 'Suez Russia' Variable



This graphic shows a map of a measure how countries' Maritime Distance to Russia is affected by the closure of the Suez Canal. The variable 'Suez Russia' is defined as the difference in log maritime traveling days in case when the Suez Canal closed minus the case when it is open. Mean: 0.063, Standard Deviation: 0.157, For non-zero values Mean: 0.330, SD: 0.199

Results

In what follows I run an Instrumental Model with two steps. On the first stage I estimate the following equation:

$$\text{IHS Trade Russia 2021}_c = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 \text{Suez}_c + \alpha_2 \text{Controls}_c + \varepsilon_c$$

where the controls are IHS Total Trade with the World and Ukraine in 2021, IHS Total Trade with Russia, Ukraine and the World in 2020, log GDP per capita, log population, a dummy on being in the UN Security Council, IHS Total Foreign Aid, IHS US Aid, several characteristics of geographical and cultural distances, and Continent FE's; c denotes the country for which we take the observation and ε is the error term. On the second stage I estimate the following:

$$y_c = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{IHS Trade}\widehat{\text{ Russia 2021}}_c + \beta_2 \text{Controls}_c + \eta_c$$

where

$$\text{IHS Trade}\widehat{\text{ Russia 2021}}_c = \text{IHS Trade Russia 2021}_c - \varepsilon_c,$$

y is a dummy for voting YES in the A/RES/ES-11/1, the controls are the same as on the first stage, c denotes the country for which we take an observation, and η is the error term. The coefficient that I am interested in is β_1.

In order to get some suggestive evidence that the variation obtained that way is exogenous I conduct a fake treatment test. I first run an OLS regression of 2021 Trade on the Suez variable, controlling for Trade in 2020. Then I run a regression of 2020 Trade on

the same variable, controlling for Trade in 2019. Finally, I also run two similar regressions for 2022 Trade with 2021 and 2020 Trade being the controls. This would show, whether there is a long-lasting effect of the blockage. I report the results in Table 17 in appendix B.

Table 9: Instrumental Regression Results

	Voting 'YES' in resolution A/RES/ES-11/1		
	Reduced Form	Single Instrument	Multiple Instruments
Suez Russia	0.003		
	(0.214)		
IHS Trade RUS '21		-0.002	-0.338
		(0.100)	(0.753)
IHS Trade RUS '20	-0.032	-0.031	-0.095
	(0.020)	(0.057)	(0.529)
IHS Trade UKR '21	0.018	0.017	1.923
	(0.027)	(0.035)	(3.853)
IHS Trade UKR '20	-0.026	-0.025	-1.268
	(0.026)	(0.073)	(2.698)
IHS Trade World '21	0.072	0.072	3.770
	(0.310)	(0.271)	(8.874)
IHS Trade World '20	-0.020	-0.019	-3.361
	(0.304)	(0.267)	(7.921)
Mean	0.804	0.804	19.7
Number of Obs.	141	141	141
Adj. R-squared	0.273	0.273	
F-stat Instrument		7.641	
Prob > F		0.007	
Shea's R-squared (RUS)			0.012
Controls	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UN-GA, voted in the resolution, have Trade Data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Limited Information Maximum Likelihood Instrumental Regression (LIML IV). The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, a dummy for being in the UN Security Council, IHS Trade of countries from/to Ukraine and the World in this and previous year as well as Foreign Aid in this and previous year.

We can see, that the coefficient on the Suez variable is not significant in neither 2020 nor 2022. On the opposite, for 2021 it is strongly significant, negative and large (about half the standard deviation). This means that having to travel more by sea towards Russia actually meant that countries would reduce trade in 2021. However, the absence

of effects in other years suggests that there are no omitted variables. We can also see that the effect appears to be temporary, since if we look at the changes from 2020 to 2022 the coefficient becomes insignificant though still of large magnitude. This might suggest the fact that trade got back to 'normal' once the Suez blockage was dealt with, so that there were rather no effects on creating alternative routes. However, we should be careful here, since 2022 trade with Russia might be very noisy.

I run two separate regressions for the instrument estimation. First, I take only the Suez Russia variable and use it to instrument for IHS Total Trade with Russia in 2021. Next, I also run a regression with Suez Russia, Suez Ukraine, and Suez Total, which is the average of the Suez closure effect relative to distance to all countries. Before looking at the IV regression results I should note that the F-statistic on the single instrument is 7.64, which means that the instrument is rather weak. I hence use the Limited Information Maximum Likelihood (LIML) instead of the Two-Stage Least-Squares (2SLS). This should help deal with the low availability of information. For the multiple instruments the situation is worse, as I obtain the Shea's R-squared of only 0.012. I also use the LIML here, but that might not be enough, so one should be careful interpreting the results.

The LIML estimator is obtained by maximizing (with respect to the coefficient β):

$$N\frac{(y-X\beta)'Z(Z'Z)^{-1}Z'(y-X\beta)}{(y-X\beta)'(y-X\beta)},$$

where y is the outcome, X is the endogenous regressor and Z is the instrument. This is proposed and used in papers like Shea (1997) and Stock and Yogo (2005).

Table 9 shows the results of the IV estimation. We can see that the results appear to be very close to zero. The Reduced form shows us that the Suez variable itself does not account for changes in voting behavior. We can also see that the amount of trade in previous years has some, but not significant coefficients. This might represent some long-term relationships, that are valued to some limited extend, and which can be disturbed by short-term shocks. One should be careful with interpretation though. The last column is rather uninformative, since the SDs are huge and the coefficients larger than one (which ideally should not be the case in a LPM with variables that take on values of greater than 1). Hence, the last column might be some evidence towards a violation of the information restriction for the instruments.

6 Conclusion

To summarize, I find that total trade appears to have some effect on UN-GA voting, though these results should be treated very carefully. There are no effects at all of trade on the implementation of sanctions. I also find that Imports of Cereals specifically have a strong and significant negative effect, while other commodities appear not to be important.

This might point towards the fact that food commodities are more important than natural resources. It could also be the case that some countries are simply dependent on Russia, while economic ties and political sympathy are less important. At the same time it appears that developing and emerging countries within themselves are not differentiated by trade amounts.

I construct an instrument for trade with Russia using the Ever Given accident in the Suez canal. I find that the exogenous variation in trade that is created by this instrument is not associated with any effects on voting behavior. This might be either because that's the actual state of the World and the LPM only reports significant coefficients due to OVB; or this could be because the LATE differs from the ATE (with short-term shocks and long-term relationships being different drivers); or finally it could be simply because the instrument is too weak. I provide some evidence toward the second explanation.

There are several ways to extend and improve this work. First, it might be reasonable to construct a weighted Suez variable instead of using one main port for each country. Especially in the case of Russia that appears to make sense. However, this goes beyond the scope of a thesis work, as computing such a measure would take up at least another month or two. Another extension that can be done is looking more into the greater variety of goods and commodities. Maybe breaking them up in food/resources, etc. In this light it might be also interesting to look more into Developing and Emerging countries as they might be affected most. Finally, it would be interesting to find out why some resolutions show to be affected by total trade or trade in specific goods, and why others are not. Taking all resolutions (not only for Russian-Ukrainian related issues), one could differentiate them into types by their content and look which types are affected by trade and which ones are not. All these ideas are out of reach in this work but would be interesting to study later on.

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A Resolutions

This Section provides information on different resolutions. I consider the votes on the following General Assembly resolutions: A/RES/ES-11/1, A/RES/ES-11/2, A/RES/ES-11/3, A/RES/ES-11/4, A/RES/ES-11/5, A/RES/ES-11/6, and A/RES/68/262. In the following I first describe the voting procedure in the UN General Assembly in the big picture. Then I describe how I chose specific resolutions of the UN-GA. After that I show the timeline of the conflict and provide information on each resolution in detail. Finally, I provide some political interpretation for votes and resolutions.

Voting in the UN General Assembly

The UN General Assembly meetings proceed either in regular or in special sessions. Regular sessions are held annually beginning on the second Tuesday of September. Special sessions may be requested by the Security Council or by a majority of the members of the United Nations (a voting for holding a special session can be in turn be asked for by any member). In each Session the members conduct plenary meetings, which are usually public but can be made private by request. In these meetings countries discuss matters of resolutions, write up proposals or amendments, and then vote on every amendment and resolution.

When put to vote, a resolution has to get a simple majority of votes *of the members present and voting* to be adopted, unless it is considered an 'important question'. The latter include recommendations with respect to the maintenance of international peace and security; elections; the admission of new Members to the United Nations, as well as their suspension or expulsion; questions relating to the operation of the trusteeship system, and budgetary questions (Rule 83). In these cases there should be a two-third majority in order to adopt a resolution. Some resolutions are adopted without vote, if the meeting decides to do so. Importantly, by 'the members present and voting' only those members are meant that are casting an affirmative or negative vote, so abstaining countries do not count (Rule 86).

Resolution-Choosing Procedure

The General Assembly resolutions are mostly recommendations and not legally binding. The UN Digital Library contains all adopted resolutions and voting data on them. Records include data on the title, the date of adoption, the agenda, the full text of the resolution, the meeting record, texts of earlier drafts and the voting data itself with each country marked as Y if they voted in favor, N if they voted against, A if they abstained and no mark if they didn't attend the vote. The Library does not contain resolutions that are rejected, so it appears that they are not published and neither are the votes on rejections.

For each resolution that I use in my Thesis I download the full text and make a small summary here in the Appendix. Descriptive Statistics on voting data itself can be found in the main text.

In order to screen out the resolutions I need I go to the United Nations Digital Library website, and to the voting data part in particular. I go to the advanced search and look for the keyword 'Ukraine' in the 'agenda' field. I take only the resolutions adopted by the General Assembly (as opposed to the Security Council) and that are voted for (as opposed to being adopted without vote). This leaves me with two subjects: 'Human Rights – Ukraine' and 'Ukraine – Political Conditions'. The former is a yearly report on the Human rights conditions in Crimea and Sevastopol conducted from 2015 until 2023. It doesn't seem too informative, so I decide to drop it. The latter is way more interesting, so I take all resolutions from that topic (six in total). I describe them below. I later also search for 'Ukraine' in the title field, which gives me additional subjects 'Armed Conflicts Prevention' and 'Armed Conflicts Mediation'. The former gives four resolutions in the period between 2018 and 2020 (which I do not look at), while the latter gives us a resolution from 2014, which might be very interesting for comparison. This A/RES/68/262 resolution I describe first here.

Crimea-Crisis. The Prequel

There is a resolution from the 27th of March 2014 called 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine' (A/RES/68/262). In it, the General Assembly affirms its commitment to the sovereignty of Ukraine; Calls upon all states to respect it; Urges all parties to pursue the peaceful resolution; Welcomes the efforts of the UN and others to assist Ukraine in protecting their rights; Underscores that the referendum held in Crimea cannot form the basis for any alteration of it's status; and Calls upon everybody not to recognize any alteration of said status.

Russo-Ukrainian conflict. The Invasion

Resolution A/RES/ES-11/1, 'Aggression against Ukraine', is the first one of the Series drafted by the General Assembly on the 2nd of March 2022 (in the 1st plenary meeting), and it mostly consists of some general points condemning the actions of the Russian Federation. Here is a quick summary: The General assembly reaffirms its commitment to the sovereignty of Ukraine, demands that the Russian Federation immediately cease its use of force against Ukraine and that the Russian Federation immediately and unconditionally reverse the decision related to the status of certain areas of the Donetsk and Luhansk regions of Ukraine, calls upon the parties to abide by the Minsk agreements, has several demands to both sides regarding civilians and humanitarian conditions, deplores the involvement of Belarus, Urges the immediate peaceful resolution of the conflict between the

Russian Federation and Ukraine, et cetera. Finally, they decide to adjourn the meeting and look for further discussion (as we can see, it took place five more times).

First Months of the war. Humanitarian Conditions. Butcha

Resolution A/RES/ES-11/2, 'Humanitarian consequences of the aggression against Ukraine', was adopted on March 24 2022 (in the 9th plenary meeting). It is a little bit more about civilians. In this resolution, the General Assembly reiterates the need for the full implementation of resolution ES-11/1; Demands an immediate cessation of the hostilities by the Russian Federation against Ukraine, in particular of any attacks against civilians and civilian objects; Also demands the protection of civilians, medical and humanitarian personnel, fleeing people, etc; Stresses that the sieges of cities in Ukraine, in particular the city of Mariupol, further aggravate the humanitarian situation for the civilian population and hamper evacuation efforts, and therefore demands to put an end to these sieges; Calls upon Member States to fully fund the United Nations Humanitarian Response Plan 2022, the flash appeal launched by the United Nations for the humanitarian response in Ukraine; Strongly encourages the continued negotiations between all parties; And again decides to adjourn the eleventh emergency special session.

Resolution A/RES/ES-11/3, 'Suspension of the rights of membership of the Russian Federation in the Human Rights Council' is a little bit more specific and has less and simpler but stronger points. It was adopted on the 7th April 2022 (in the 10th plenary meeting). Here, the General Assembly decides to suspend the rights of membership in the Human Rights Council of the Russian Federation; Also decides to review the matter, as appropriate; Further decides to adjourn the eleventh emergency special session of the General Assembly temporarily and to authorize the President of the General Assembly to resume its meetings upon request from Member States.

A few more months into the war. Mobilization in Russia

Resolution A/RES/ES-11/4, 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine: defending the principles of the Charter of the United Nations' was adopted on the 12th October 2022 (in the 14th plenary meeting) and is mostly about annexation. Here, the General Assembly reaffirms its commitment to the territorial integrity of Ukraine; Condemns the organization by the Russian Federation of illegal so-called referendums; Declares that the so-called referendums have no validity; Calls upon all States, international organizations and United Nations specialized agencies not to recognize any alteration of the status of any region (Donetsk, Kherson, Luhansk and Zaporizhzhia); Demands that the Russian Federation immediately and unconditionally reverse its decisions of 21 February and 29 September 2022 related to the status of certain regions; Welcomes the efforts of anyone to respond to the humanitarian and refugee crisis; And again decides to adjourn the meeting.

Resolution A/RES/ES-11/5, 'Furtherance of remedy and reparation for aggression against Ukraine' has also a little bit stronger points about reparations. It was adopted on the 14th November 2022 (in the 15th plenary meeting). The General Assembly one more time Reaffirms its commitment to the sovereignty of Ukraine; Recognizes that the Russian Federation must be held to account for any violations of international law; Recognizes also the need for the establishment, in cooperation with Ukraine, of an international mechanism for *reparation* for damage, loss or injury, and arising from the internationally wrongful acts of the Russian Federation in or against Ukraine; Recommends the creation by Member States, in cooperation with Ukraine, of an international register of damage etc; Again, decides to adjourn the meeting.

Resolution A/RES/ES-11/6, 'Principles of the Charter of the United Nations underlying a comprehensive, just and lasting peace in Ukraine', the last one for now, was adopted on 23 February 2023 (one year after the beginning of the conflict, in the 19th plenary meeting). It has rather not many new points, appears to be rather symbolic (one year of conflict), with the only difference to previous resolutions being that it also addresses some concerns with the nuclear sector. Here, the General Assembly Underscores the need to reach, as soon as possible, a comprehensive, just and lasting peace in Ukraine; Once again reaffirms its commitment to the territorial integrity of Ukraine; Reiterates its demand that the Russian Federation immediately, completely and unconditionally withdraw all of its military forces; has some demands regarding prisoners; Again has some demands about civilians and humanitarian conditions; Emphasizes the need to ensure accountability for the most serious crimes under international law committed on the territory of Ukraine; Urges all Member States to cooperate in the spirit of solidarity to address the global impacts of the war on food security, energy, finance, the environment and nuclear security and safety; And finally decides to adjourn the meeting once again (a new resolution has not been formed since then).

B Tables

Table 10: The effect of Trade Volumes on UNGA-voting in Developing and Emerging Countries

	Voting YES in Resolution A/RES/ES-11/1					
	Developing		Emerging		Dev & Emg	
IHS Trade Russia	-0.026	-0.024	-0.012	-0.011	-0.026	-0.025
	(0.020)	(0.021)	(0.125)	(0.170)	(0.020)	(0.020)
IHS Trade Ukraine	0.012	0.012	0.006	0.012	0.019	0.021
	(0.021)	(0.021)	(0.126)	(0.140)	(0.020)	(0.020)
IHS Trade World	-0.135	-0.152	-0.355	-0.366	-0.077	-0.089
	(0.110)	(0.119)	(0.289)	(0.335)	(0.102)	(0.108)
IHS Total Aid		-0.017		-0.004		-0.017
		(0.013)		(0.015)		(0.014)
IHS US Aid		-0.004		0.009		0.012
		(0.029)		(0.063)		(0.024)
Mean	0.699	0.699	0.818	0.818	0.745	0.745
Number of Obs	83	83	33	33	105	105
Adj. R-squared	0.248	0.232	0.409	0.281	0.211	0.198
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All Developing (column 1) and Emerging (Column 2) countries (except Russia and Ukraine; column 3 represents the union of the two sets; developing and emerging countries are described in detail in the text) that are members of the UNGA, voted in the resolution, and have Trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text, with Data taken as of the year 2021. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UN Security Council.

Table 11: The effect of Trade Volumes on UNGA-voting in additional resolutions

	Voting YES in the resolution									
	ES-11/2 (24.03.2022)		ES-11/4 (12.10.2022)		ES-11/5 (14.11.2022)		ES-11/6 (23.02.2023)		68/262 (27.03.2014)	
IHS Trade Russia	-0.056**	-0.055**	-0.013	-0.012	0.006	0.005	-0.036**	-0.035**	0.006	0.003
	(0.022)	(0.023)	(0.020)	(0.020)	(0.024)	(0.024)	(0.017)	(0.017)	(0.019)	(0.019)
IHS Trade Ukraine	0.040*	0.040*	0.017	0.016	0.016	0.016	0.018	0.018	-0.003	-0.002
	(0.023)	(0.023)	(0.019)	(0.020)	(0.025)	(0.025)	(0.019)	(0.019)	(0.017)	(0.017)
IHS Trade World	0.025	0.021	-0.031	-0.028	-0.192**	-0.195**	0.027	0.023	-0.050	-0.032
	(0.072)	(0.073)	(0.080)	(0.079)	(0.082)	(0.083)	(0.071)	(0.072)	(0.094)	(0.092)
IHS Total Aid		-0.011		0.014		-0.006		-0.015		-0.002
		(0.013)		(0.016)		(0.016)		(0.012)		(0.023)
IHS US Aid		0.005		-0.023		0.011		0.010		-0.027
		(0.019)		(0.019)		(0.021)		(0.019)		(0.025)
Mean	0.772	0.772	0.793	0.793	0.539	0.539	0.794	0.794	0.590	0.590
Number of Obs.	146	146	146	146	142	142	142	142	144	144
Adj. R-Squared	0.301	0.292	0.267	0.265	0.349	0.339	0.244	0.237	0.287	0.289
F-Test	25.08	47.33	16.52	12.36	20.50	18.19	29.06	35.56		
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000		
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text with Data taken as of the year 2021. The resolutions in question are the 'Humanitarian consequences of the aggression against Ukraine', 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine: defending the principles of the Charter of the United Nations', 'Furtherance of remedy and reparation for aggression against Ukraine', 'Principles of the Charter of the United Nations underlying a comprehensive, just and lasting peace in Ukraine' and 'Territorial Integrity of Ukraine' resolutions accordingly. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UN Security Council.

Table 12: The effect of Trade per Capita on UNGA-voting in additional resolutions

	Voting YES in the resolution									
	ES-11/2 (24.03.2022)		ES-11/4 (12.10.2022)		ES-11/5 (14.11.2022)		ES-11/6 (23.02.2023)		68/262 (27.03.2014)	
IHS Russia PC	-0.095***	-0.097***	-0.040	-0.039	0.013	0.006	-0.058*	-0.058*	0.020	0.019
	(0.032)	(0.034)	(0.032)	(0.034)	(0.040)	(0.040)	(0.030)	(0.032)	(0.043)	(0.043)
IHS Ukraine PC	0.135***	0.135***	0.078**	0.078**	0.085*	0.084*	0.074*	0.074*	0.045	0.047
	(0.037)	(0.037)	(0.036)	(0.037)	(0.044)	(0.044)	(0.040)	(0.040)	(0.051)	(0.052)
IHS World PC	0.004	0.010	-0.034	-0.025	-0.230**	-0.225**	0.011	0.011	-0.094	-0.091
	(0.080)	(0.083)	(0.084)	(0.085)	(0.093)	(0.094)	(0.078)	(0.083)	(0.097)	(0.102)
IHS Total Aid PC		0.016		0.031		0.003		0.001		0.028
		(0.021)		(0.022)		(0.028)		(0.021)		(0.032)
IHS US Aid PC		-0.014		-0.041		0.017		-0.001		-0.027
		(0.029)		(0.031)		(0.033)		(0.031)		(0.034)
Mean	0.772	0.772	0.793	0.793	0.539	0.539	0.794	0.794	0.590	0.590
Number of Obs.	146	146	146	146	142	142	142	142	144	144
Adj. R-Squared	0.349	0.341	0.289	0.293	0.367	0.359	0.259	0.246	0.300	0.295
F-Test	69.47	41.97	25.81	17.35	22.62	18.83	37.08	33.74		
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000		
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text with Data taken as of the year 2021. The resolutions in question are the 'Humanitarian consequences of the aggression against Ukraine', 'Territorial integrity of Ukraine: defending the principles of the Charter of the United Nations', 'Furtherance of remedy and reparation for aggression against Ukraine', 'Principles of the Charter of the United Nations underlying a comprehensive, just and lasting peace in Ukraine' and 'Territorial Integrity of Ukraine' resolutions accordingly. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UN Security Council.

Table 13: The effect of Trade Volumes on Sanctions

	Country Imposed Sanctions by Today (2024)			
	2021	2021	2013	2013
IHS Trade Russia	0.009	0.014	0.003	0.003
	(0.010)	(0.011)	(0.005)	(0.006)
IHS Trade Ukraine	-0.000	0.001	-0.005	-0.005
	(0.009)	(0.009)	(0.006)	(0.006)
IHS Trade World	-0.042	-0.042	-0.069	-0.066
	(0.051)	(0.050)	(0.055)	(0.057)
IHS Total Foreign Aid		-0.000		-0.010
		(0.011)		(0.008)
IHS US Foreign Aid		-0.031*		0.003
		(0.018)		(0.013)
Mean	0.592	0.049	0.278	0.278
Number of Obs.	152	152	162	162
Adj. R-Squared	0.756	0.769	0.711	0.709
F-Test	107.5	82.30	84.99	71.40
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text, with Data taken as of the year 2013 (columns 1 and 2) and 2021 (columns 3 and 4). 'Imposing Sanctions' is defined as being present on the 'Countries unfriendly to Russia' list published by the Russian Federation. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UNSC.

Table 14: The effect of Trade per Capita on Sanctions

	Country Imposed Sanctions by Today (2024)			
	2021	2021	2013	2013
IHS Trade RUS PC	0.028	0.042	0.025	0.025
	(0.022)	(0.027)	(0.020)	(0.021)
IHS Trade UKR PC	0.009	0.011	0.044**	0.044*
	(0.024)	(0.022)	(0.022)	(0.022)
IHS Trade World PC	-0.062	-0.070	-0.129**	-0.130**
	(0.051)	(0.055)	(0.053)	(0.054)
IHS Total Aid PC		-0.002		-0.020*
		(0.021)		(0.012)
IHS US Aid PC		-0.038		0.020
		(0.023)		(0.022)
Mean	0.592	0.049	0.278	0.278
Number of Obs.	152	152	162	162
Adj. R-Squared	0.759	0.769	0.728	0.729
F-Test	108.9	84.18	103.2	65.13
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text, with Data taken as of the year 2013 (columns 1 and 2) and 2021 (columns 3 and 4). 'Imposing Sanctions' is defined as being present on the 'Countries unfriendly to Russia' list published by the Russian Federation. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, and a dummy for being in the UNSC.

Table 15: The effect of Import/Export Volumes on sanctions and UNGA-voting behavior

	Voting YES in resolution A/RES/ES-11/1 (02.03.2022)			
IHS Export to Russia	-0.017	-0.017		
	(0.014)	(0.014)		
IHS Import from Russia	-0.024**	-0.025*		
	(0.012)	(0.013)		
IHS Net Exp to Russia			0.001	0.001
			(0.002)	(0.002)
IHS Total Trade Russia			-0.038**	-0.036**
			(0.017)	(0.017)
IHS Total Foreign Aid		-0.010		-0.010
		(0.012)		(0.012)
IHS US Foreign Aid		0.009		0.002
		(0.020)		(0.018)
Mean	0.804	0.804	0.804	0.804
Number of Obs.	144	144	144	144
Adj. R-Squared	0.279	0.269	0.278	0.269
F-Test	22.84	36.42	43.57	108.5
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that have trade data available at least relative to the World and voted in the resolution (columns 1 and 2). Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text with Data taken as of the year 2021. 'Imposing Sanctions' is defined as being present on the 'Countries unfriendly to Russia' list published by the Russian Federation. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, a dummy for being in the UN Security Council, as well as IHS Imports and Exports (Net Exports and Total Trades) of countries from/to Ukraine and the World.

Table 16: The effect of Import/Export per Capita on sanctions and UNGA-voting behavior

	Voting YES in resolution A/RES/ES-11/1 (02.03.2022)			
IHS Export to RUS PC	-0.024	-0.026		
	(0.032)	(0.033)		
IHS Import from RUS PC	-0.054*	-0.055		
	(0.032)	(0.034)		
IHS Net Exp to RUS PC			-0.010	-0.010
			(0.009)	(0.009)
IHS Total Trade RUS PC			-0.076**	-0.076**
			(0.032)	(0.035)
IHS Total Aid PC		0.008		0.012
		(0.021)		(0.021)
IHS US Aid PC		-0.006		-0.013
		(0.029)		(0.028)
Mean	0.804	0.804	0.804	0.804
Number of Obs.	144	144	144	144
Adj. R-Squared	0.279	0.269	0.278	0.269
F-Test	22.84	36.42	43.57	108.5
Prob > F	0.000	0.000	0.000	0.000
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity, taking the HC3-type, but not clustered. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that have trade data available at least relative to the World and voted in the resolution (columns 1 and 2). Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). The definitions of the regressors are in the text with Data taken as of the year 2021. 'Imposing Sanctions' is defined as being present on the 'Countries unfriendly to Russia' list published by the Russian Federation. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, a dummy for being in the UN Security Council, as well as IHS Imports and Exports PC (Net Exports PC and Trade PC) of countries from/to Ukraine and the World.

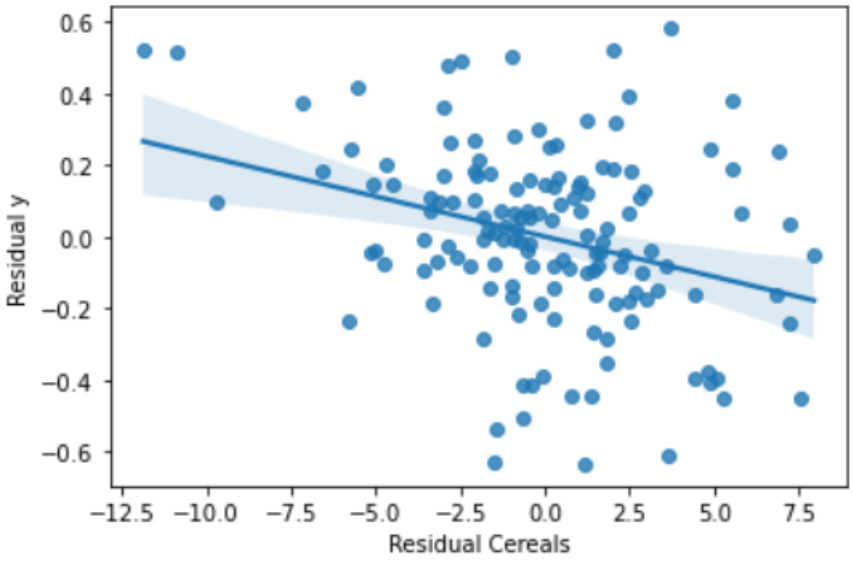
Table 17: Fake Treatment on the First Stage

	IHS Trade Russia This Year			
	2020	2021	2022	2022
Suez Russia	-0.678	-1.835***	0.728	-1.557
	(0.878)	(0.668)	(1.022)	(1.181)
IHS Trade RUS Previous	0.365***	0.522***	1.098***	
	(0.131)	(0.0876)	(0.121)	
IHS Trade RUS Pre Suez				0.695***
				(0.208)
IHS Trade Ukraine	0.0581	-0.232	0.405*	-0.0432
	(0.205)	(0.190)	(0.238)	(0.294)
IHS Trade World	3.471	-0.558	2.506***	1.581
	(2.223)	(0.917)	(0.856)	(1.188)
Mean	19.5	19.7	19.9	19.9
Number of Obs.	150	149	132	132
Adj. R-squared	0.883	0.919	0.954	0.891
Controls	Y	Y	Y	Y
Continent FE	Y	Y	Y	Y

Notes: Standard errors (in brackets) are robust to heteroskedasticity. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that are members of the UNGA, voted in the resolution, have Trade Data available at least relative to the World. Econometric methodology: Linear Probability Model (LPM). Previous stands for taking data from one year before the estimation, while Pre Suez stands for the year 2020. The controls are physical distances between capitals and biggest cities of each country to Moscow and Kiev accordingly, as well as weighted distances between cities in general, a dummy on contingency, common official language, common ethnical language, several dummies on colonial relationships, log population, log GDP per capita, a dummy for being in the UN Security Council, IHS Trade of countries from/to Ukraine and the World in this and previous year as well as Foreign Aid in this and previous year.

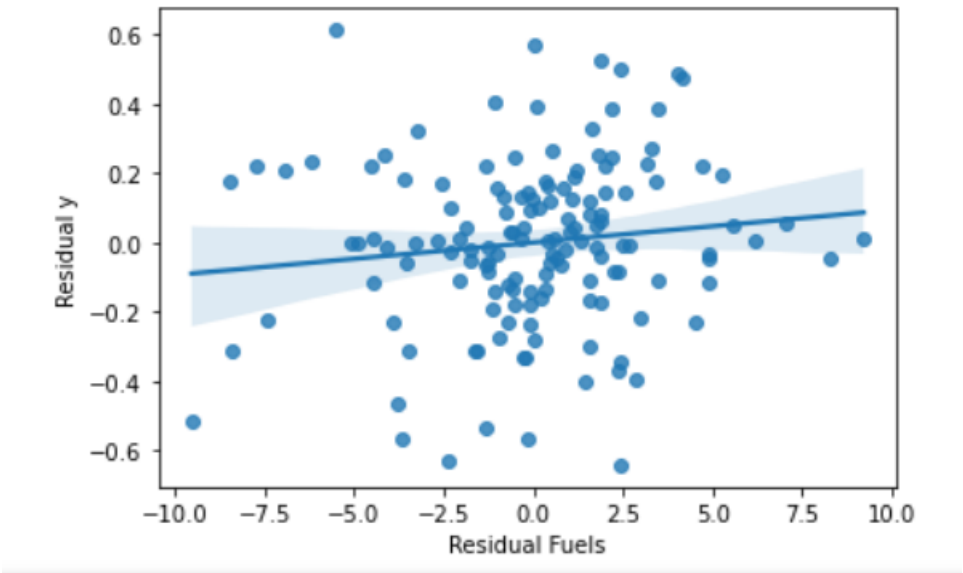
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Figure 2: Voting YES and Russian Cereals



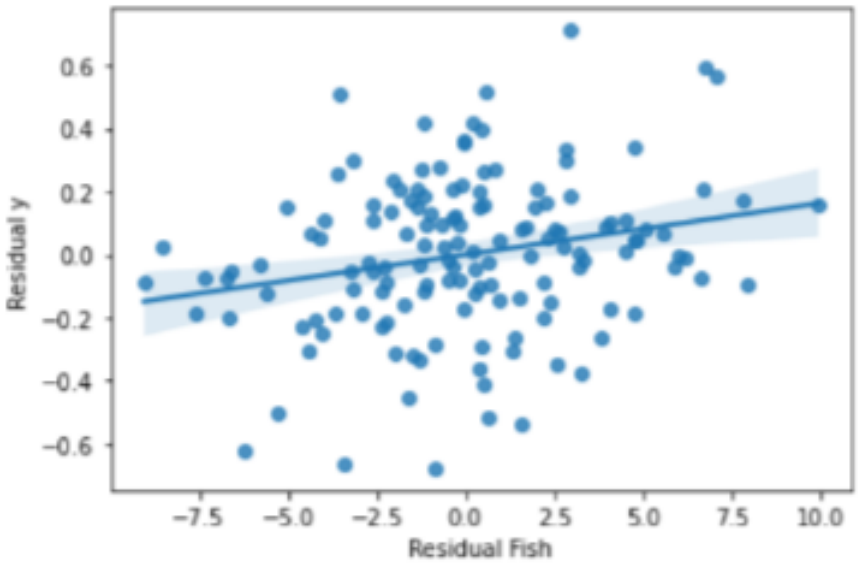
Notes: This figure shows a scatter plot as well as a fitted line (with a 95% interval) for the residuals of YES-voting behavior on the residuals of IHS Imports of Russian Cereals. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. The controls are all the regressors and controls from Table 7.

Figure 3: Voting YES and Russian Fuels



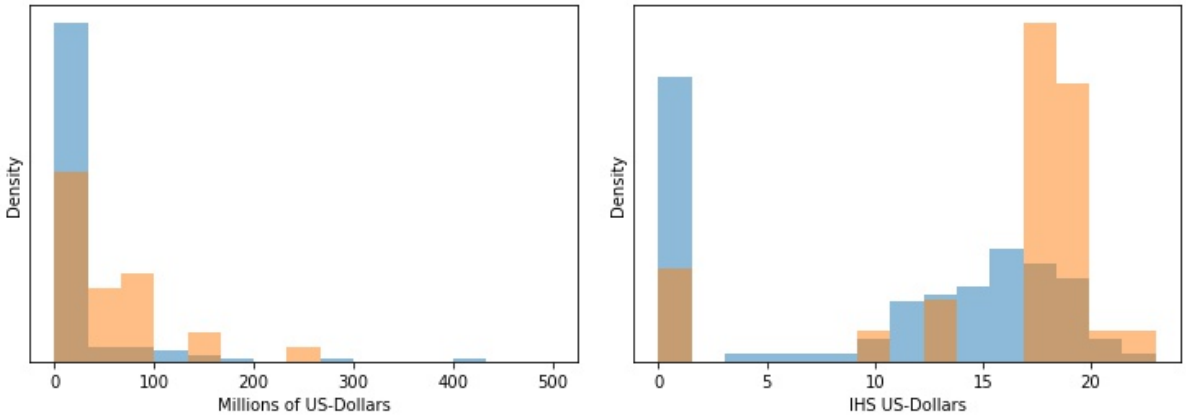
Notes: This figure shows a scatter plot as well as a fitted line (with a 95% interval) for the residuals of YES-voting behavior on the residuals of IHS Imports of Russian fuels. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. The controls are all the regressors and controls from Table 7.

Figure 4: Voting YES and Ukrainian Fish



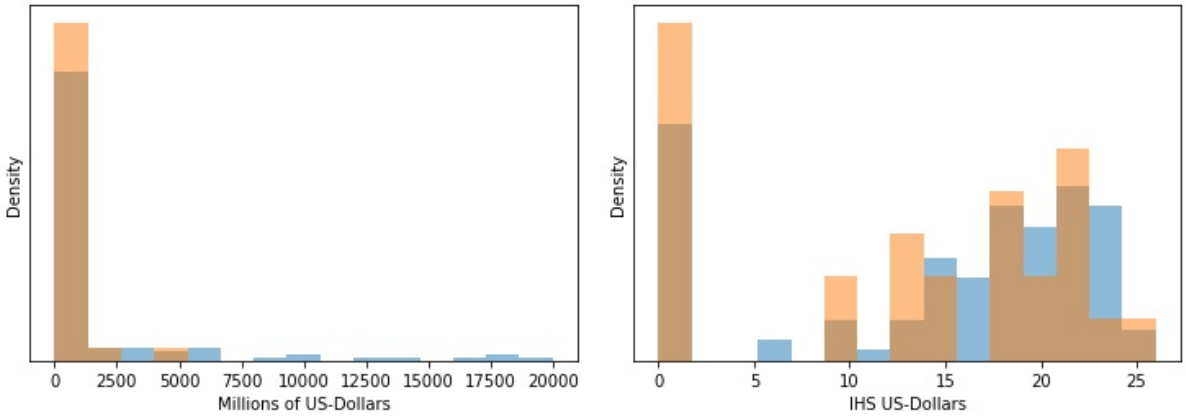
Notes: This figure shows a scatter plot as well as a fitted line (with a 95% interval) for the residuals of YES-voting behavior on the residuals of IHS Imports of Ukrainian fish. Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World. The controls are all the regressors and controls from Table 7.

Figure 5: Russian Cereals Distribution



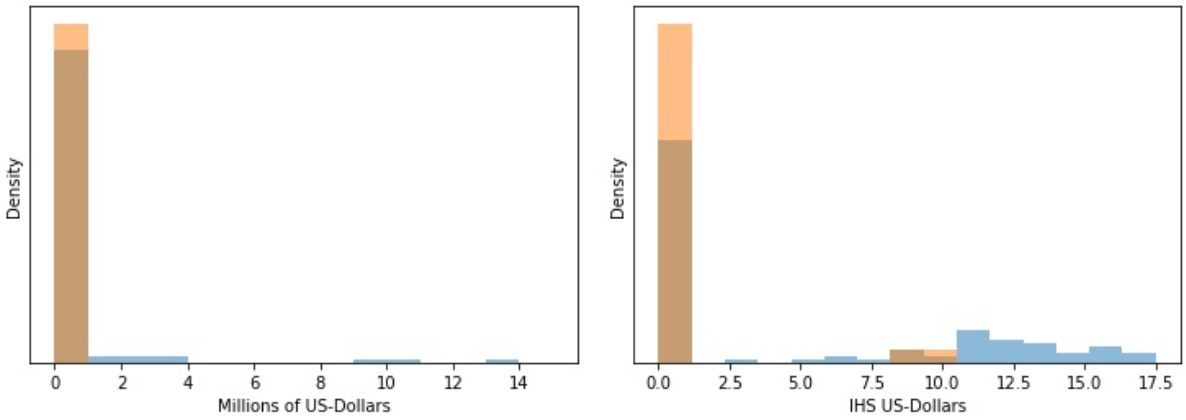
Notes: This figure shows overlapped density-histograms of Total (left) and IHS (right) Imports of Russian Cereals for countries that voted in favor (blue) and those that voted against or abstained (orange). Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World.

Figure 6: Russian Fuels Distribution



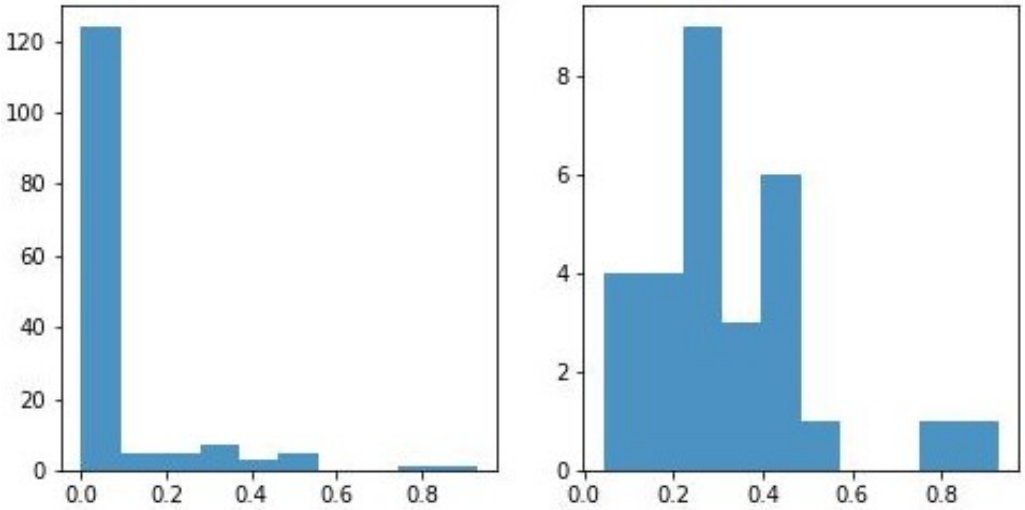
Notes: This figure shows overlapped density-histograms of Total (left) and IHS (right) Imports of Russian Fuels for countries that voted in favor (blue) and those that voted against or abstained (orange). Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World.

Figure 7: Ukrainian Fish Distribution



Notes: This figure shows overlapped density-histograms of Total (left) and IHS (right) Imports of Ukrainian Fish for countries that voted in favor (blue) and those that voted against or abstained (orange). Sample: All countries (except Russia and Ukraine) that voted in the resolution and have trade data available at least relative to the World.

Figure 8: Histogram of the 'Suez Russia' Variable



This graphic shows the distribution of 'Suez Russia' wich is defined as the difference in log maritime traveling days in case when the Suez Canal closed minus the case when it is open Mean: 0.063, Standard Deviation: 0.157, For non-zero values Mean: 0.330, SD: 0.199